Department said the extradition request met all necessary requirements, but it still did not go through.

Aware Snowden might be planning to leave China, the State Department contacted countries he might travel to or through. They told foreign diplomatic and law enforcement officials that Snowden was wanted in the United States and should only be permitted to travel back home. The FBI, CIA, the State Department, and other agencies met almost every day, trying to figure out how to capture Snowden. They hoped he would be foolish enough to get on an airplane and fly over US-friendly airspace, so the plane could be forced to land. Snowden was not that foolish. "He goes to the very countries that have, at best, very tense relationships with the United States," US Representative Ileana Ros-Lehtinen told a reporter.[1] Ecuador, for example, had rejected previous requests to help the United States in its attempts to prosecute WikiLeaks founder Julian Assange by letting him stay in its embassy in London, England.

Criminal Charges

On June 14, 2013, the Justice Department charged Snowden with theft of government property, unauthorized communication of national defense

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